

MODULE 1

# Board/PE-ready framing of the ROI argument

Leadership & the Investment Case

Workshop deliverable · template

***For a 50-engineer team: ~£120k/year in tooling for output that would otherwise need well over 100 engineers.***

## The argument in three lines

- › AI dev tooling costs ~£150–200/seat/month and delivers ~3–5x on suitable work.
- › We prove it on real work in 8 weeks with a measured before/after — not a promise.
- › The real cost is delay: output foregone at 3–5x dwarfs the tooling spend.

## The economics

Figures shown are directional, drawn from D55 delivery experience — confirm with the client's finance team. Pricing is provisional (see working-assumptions.md).

| LINE                            | ILLUSTRATIVE (50 ENGINEERS)     | YOUR FIGURE |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------|
| Annual tooling spend            | ~£120k                          | £ __        |
| Productivity uplift             | ~3–5x on suitable work          | __x         |
| Equivalent engineering capacity | 150–250 engineers of output     | __          |
| Cost per £ of added output      | fraction of a salaried engineer | £ __        |

## The valuation angle (for PE-backed orgs)

AI-native engineering is increasingly read as a valuation signal: more output per head, faster time-to-market, and a defensible operating model. For a portfolio company this is an exit-multiple conversation, not just a cost line.

## Risks & mitigations

| RISK THE BOARD WILL RAISE              | OUR MITIGATION                                                           |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Can we trust AI-generated code?"      | Module 3 — testing gates + governance so we ship <i>safely</i> at speed. |
| "Will it actually land with the team?" | Module 4 — Four Fears diagnostic addresses resistance head-on.           |
| "How do we know it's working?"         | The metrics scorecard proves ROI with hard numbers in 8 weeks.           |

| RISK THE BOARD WILL RAISE           | OUR MITIGATION                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Are we locked into a consultancy?" | D55 embeds, proves, enables, then exits — you keep the capability. |

# The ask

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Approve the mandate and fund the 8-week prove-it. If the numbers don't land, you don't scale — and you keep the assessment, the roadmap, and the scorecard.